DOST Meeting Management Technical Specification

Last updated: 2026-09-29

Contents

1. Purpose
2. Users and Roles
3. System Architecture
4. Core Workflows
5. Database Design
6. API Interface
7. Security Requirements
8. Non-Functional Characteristics
9. Assumptions and Constraints
10. Deployment
11. Testing and Validation
12. Delivered Scope

1. Purpose

DOST Meeting Management is a web application for scheduling meetings, collecting invitee availability, confirming meeting times, managing materials and recordings, maintaining minutes, tracking action items, and turning recordings into reviewable AI-generated summaries and action items.

This specification is written for client review. It describes delivered behavior, security, non-functional characteristics, assumptions, and deployment.

2. Users and Roles

2.1 User Types

User type	Description	Main goals
Staff user	DOST staff member with an email/password account.	View dashboard, join meetings, submit availability, complete action items.
Meeting owner	Person responsible for a meeting.	Schedule, confirm, and manage the meeting and its records.
Organizer	Participant with the organizer role.	Help manage participants, files, recordings, and minutes.
Attendee	Participant with the attendee or optional role.	View meeting records, contribute files and action items, request meeting changes.
Administrator	Staff member with the `admin` account role.	Manage accounts and roles; view and manage all meetings; use the app as any staff.
IT administrator	Client infrastructure operator.	Configure environments, operate deployments, monitor health.

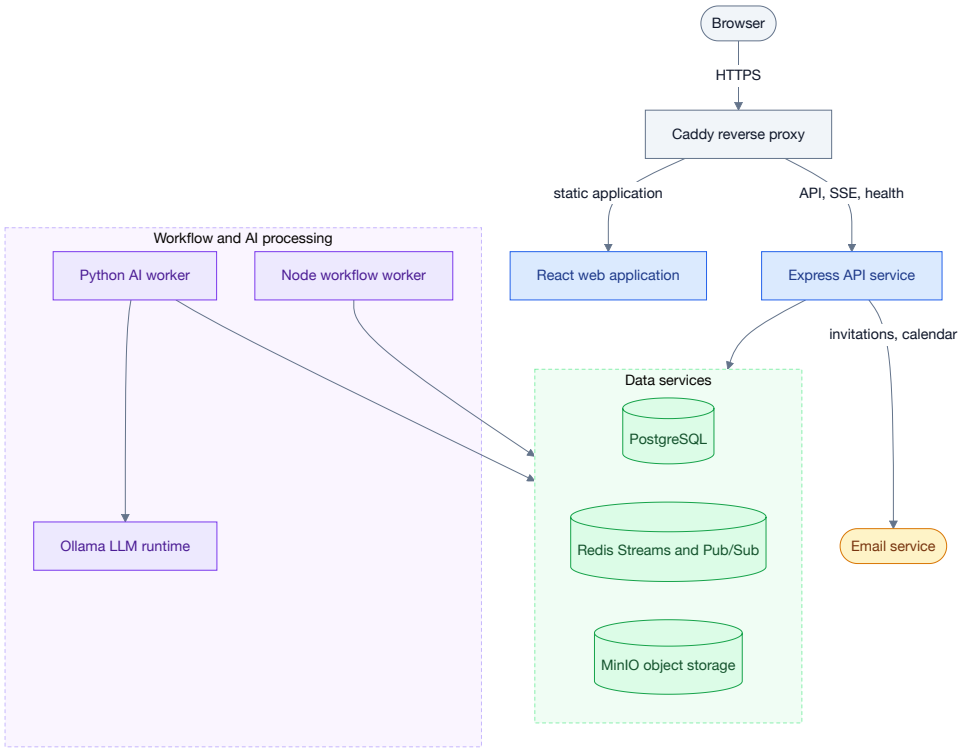
2.2 Role Model

Level	Roles	Scope
Account	`staff` (default), `admin`	Whole system. Admin can do everything staff can, plus manage accounts and view/manage all meetings.
Meeting	`owner`, `organizer`, `attendee`, `optional`	One meeting. The owner is always an organizer. Meeting roles are assigned per meeting.

A person can hold different meeting roles in different meetings. Permissions combine both levels (see section 7.2).

3. System Architecture

3.1 High-Level Architecture



Caddy is the only public entrypoint. The browser loads the React application from Caddy and sends same-origin API requests to it; Caddy forwards them to the private API service.

3.2 System Components

Component	Technology	Responsibility
Web application	React single-page application	Dashboard, meetings, scheduling, minutes, files, action items, admin, audio extraction from video.
API service	Node.js and Express	Business rules, authorization, validation, workflow transitions, SSE.

Component	Technology	Responsibility
Node workflow worker	Node.js worker runtime	Dispatches workflow outbox events and persists AI results.
Python AI worker	Python, Whisper, Redis Streams	Transcribes recordings; generates summaries and action suggestions.
Ollama	Private local LLM runtime	Structured analysis of completed transcripts.
Database	PostgreSQL	Authoritative business data and workflow state.
Object storage	MinIO	Meeting files, recordings, and AI artifacts.
Redis	Redis Streams and Pub/Sub	AI commands and results; workflow-status invalidations.
Reverse proxy	Caddy	TLS, static delivery, API routing, SSE.

3.3 Application Modules

Module	Summary
Authentication and accounts	Login, registration, session validation, admin user and role management.
Access control	Account roles and meeting roles enforced by one central permission definition.
Dashboard and notifications	Upcoming meetings, requests, action items, notification feed with read/archive.
Meeting repository and detail	Search and filter meetings; participants, files, minutes, recording, action items.
Scheduling requests	Time options, invitations by email, availability, deadline, confirmation.
Calendar invitations	iCalendar emails when a meeting is created, updated, or cancelled.
Change requests	Attendees privately ask the owner to change a meeting.
Files and minutes	Upload, download, delete materials; draft, approve, publish minutes.
Recording-to-minutes workflow	Audio or video recording, transcription, analysis, review, live status updates.
AI review	Summary applied to minutes; action-item suggestions accepted, edited, or rejected.

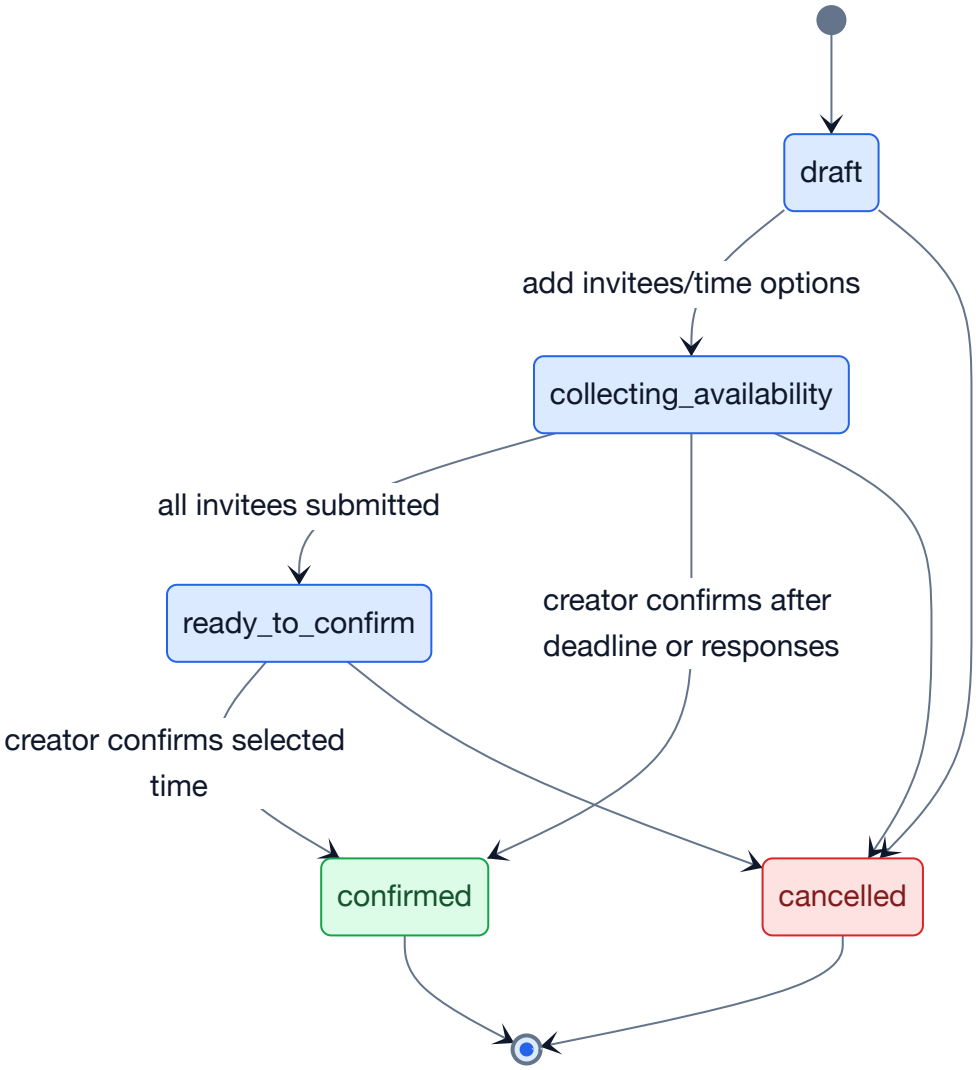
4. Core Workflows

4.1 Authentication

1. User submits email and password.
2. API validates credentials and returns a session token and user profile.
3. The web application sends the token with every protected API call.
4. The API rejects unauthenticated or unauthorized requests.

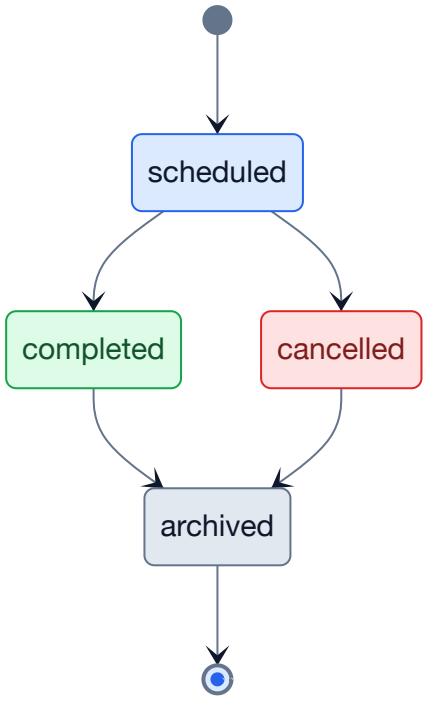
Registration is currently self-service, and new accounts receive the `staff` role. Only an admin can change a role.

4.2 Meeting Request Scheduling



- A meeting request exists before a meeting is created.
- The creator sends invitations by email. Each invitee gets a personal, expiring link and can respond without signing in; invitees with accounts can also respond in the application.
- The response deadline closes submissions but does not cancel the request.
- The creator can confirm after the deadline even if some invitees did not respond.
- Confirming creates the meeting, adds known invitees as participants, and emails a confirmation.

4.3 Meeting Lifecycle and Calendar Invitations



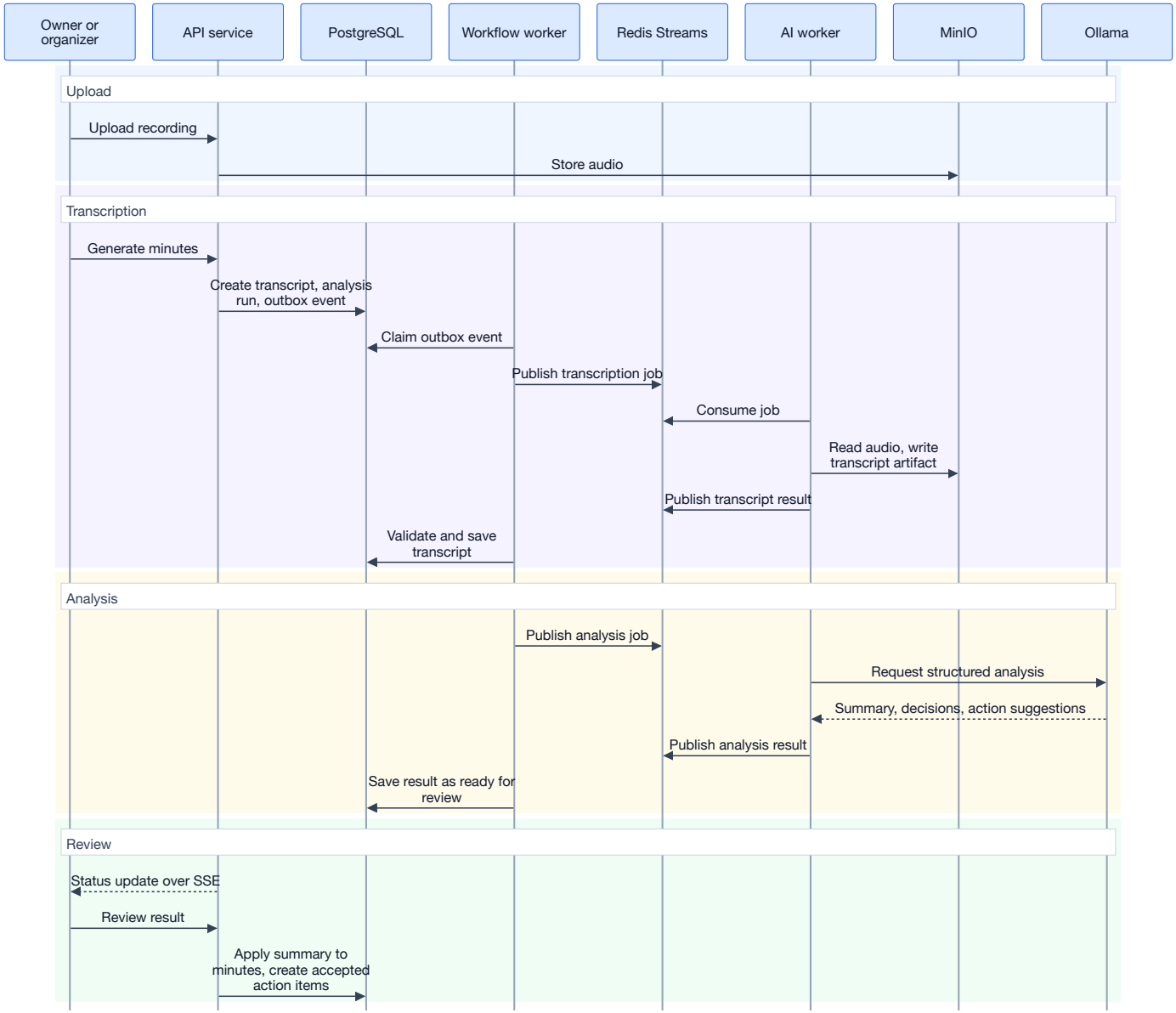
Status transitions are forward-only. Archived meetings are terminal.

When a meeting is created, updated, or cancelled, participants and emailed invitees receive an iCalendar (`.ics`) email. A sequence number lets calendar applications update or cancel the same event. Delivery is best effort: a failed email does not block the change.

4.4 Files, Recordings, and Minutes

- Participants upload, list, and download meeting materials. Owners, organizers, and admins delete them. Download links are short-lived.
- A recording can be picked as an audio file (MP3, WAV, M4A) or a video (MP4, MOV, WebM, MKV). For a video, the browser copies the audio track into an `.m4a` file and uploads only that; the video is never sent to the server. The step needs no re-encoding, so it typically takes seconds.
- A meeting has one active recording. Uploading stores the audio only; replacing it must be requested explicitly and archives the previous one.
- An owner or organizer starts generation explicitly. It requires the AI pipeline to be enabled.
- Minutes move through `draft` , `approved` , and `published` (see 4.6).
- Applying AI-generated content never approves or publishes minutes. A version check prevents overwriting concurrent edits.

4.5 Recording Analysis Workflow



- PostgreSQL holds the authoritative workflow state. Redis carries commands, results, and status invalidations only; audio and transcript text are never placed in Redis.
- Only one generation runs per recording at a time.
- Failed or duplicate deliveries are handled by bounded retries (three attempts by default) and guarded state transitions.
- Human review is mandatory. AI output is proposed, never applied automatically:
  - Each analysis run records its transcript, provider, model, and prompt version, and links each suggestion to the transcript passages that support it.
  - An owner or organizer can accept, edit, or reject each suggested action item. Accepting creates the action item and notifies the assignee; the reviewer and time are recorded.
  - If an accepted action item is later deleted, its suggestion is marked withdrawn.

4.6 Minutes Review and Approval

AI output never becomes minutes on its own. A person reviews it, applies it to the draft minutes, and then sets the minutes status.

Step	Who	Result
Review the analysis	Owner, organizer, admin	Accept, edit, or reject each suggested action item. Accepted suggestions become action items and notify the assignee.
Apply the summary to minutes	Owner, organizer, admin	The generated summary fills the minutes content. Human-written discussion and decision fields are kept. Status stays `draft`.
Approve	Owner, organizer, admin	The minutes status is set to `approved`.
Publish	Owner, organizer, admin	The minutes status is set to `published`.

- Applying is explicit. If someone edited the minutes in the meantime, the apply is rejected with a conflict and nothing is overwritten (version check).
- Every participant can read the minutes in any status; the status does not restrict who can read them.
- There is no separate approver role: whoever can edit the minutes can approve and publish them.
- The status can be changed in any direction, for example back to `draft` to reopen the minutes.
- Each minutes record keeps the transcript it was generated from.

4.7 Attendee Change Requests

- An attendee or optional participant can send the owner a private message (1–2000 characters) asking for a meeting change.
- The owner is notified, reads messages in a change-request inbox, and can mark them read.
- Organizers and admins cannot read these messages.

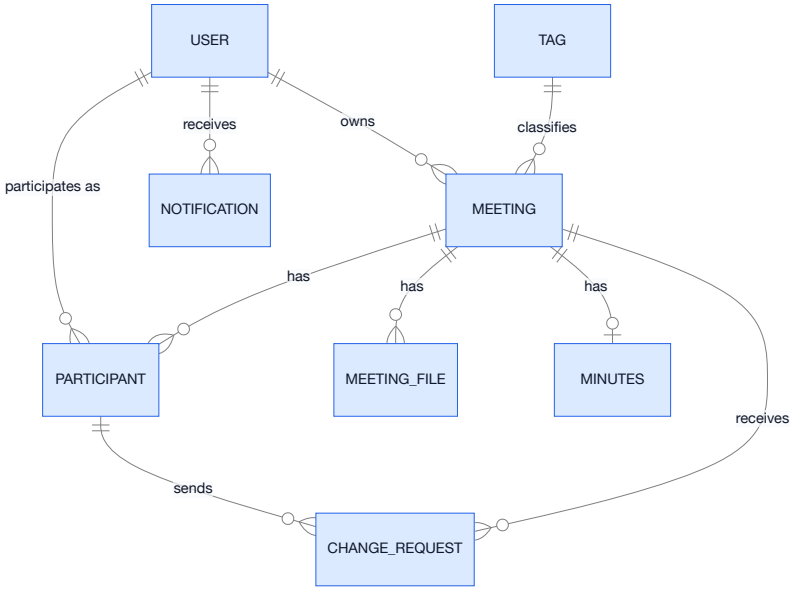
5. Database Design

Schema changes are managed as versioned SQL migrations (`0001` – `0040`).

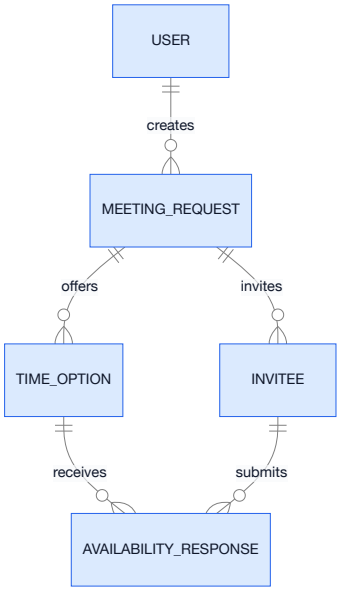
5.1 Entity Relationship Overview

The model is shown in three parts; section 5.2 describes every entity.

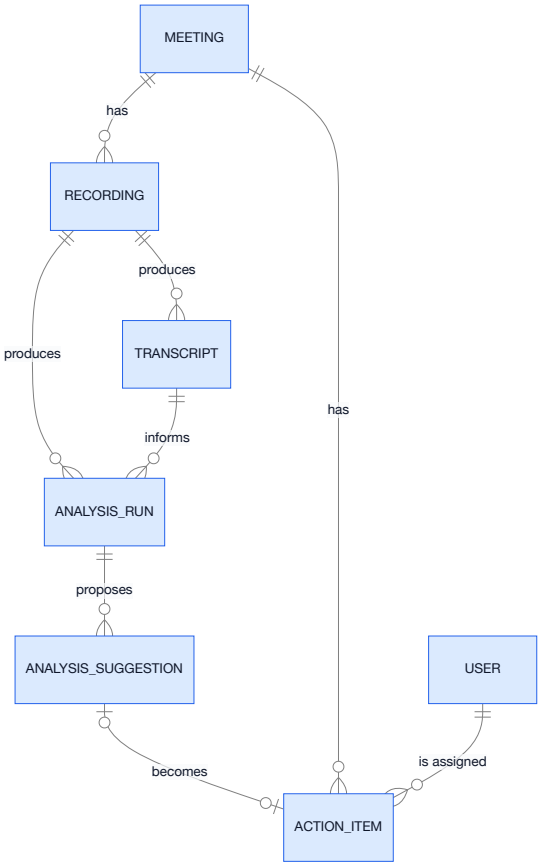
Meetings and participants



Scheduling requests



Recordings and AI review



5.2 Logical Data Model

Entity	Purpose
User	Staff account with role (`staff` or `admin`) and department.
Meeting	Scheduled meeting with owner, status, tag, and calendar version.
Participant	Meeting membership and meeting role.
Meeting file	Metadata for uploaded materials.
Action item	Task attached to a meeting; may have one assignee.
Meeting request	Scheduling poll before a meeting exists.
Time option	Candidate date/time for a request.
Invitee	Person invited to respond; may link to a user; holds a hashed, expiring invitation token.
Availability response	An invitee's answer for one time option.
Tag	Meeting classification.
Recording	Meeting audio metadata.
Transcript	Whisper transcript, timestamped segments, and status.
Analysis run	Generated summary, key discussions, decisions, and provenance.
Analysis suggestion	Proposed action item awaiting review, with reviewer and outcome.

Entity	Purpose
Workflow outbox	Durable workflow commands awaiting dispatch.
Minutes	One minutes record per meeting, with status, version, and the transcript it came from.
Notification	Persisted in-app notification for one recipient.
Change request	Private attendee message to the meeting owner, with read state.

5.3 Data Integrity Requirements

- Use stable unique identifiers and enforce relationships at the database level.
- Restrict status values (meetings, requests, minutes, transcripts, analysis runs, suggestions, action items) and account roles (`staff` , `admin`).
- Allow one selected time option per request and one active recording per meeting.
- Require provenance before an analysis run can be offered for review.
- Allow a suggestion to be accepted once and to create at most one action item.
- Remove change requests when their participant or meeting is removed.
- Store invitation tokens hashed only.
- Index common user, meeting, status, date, search, and notification queries.

6. API Interface

All APIs are exposed under the same domain through the reverse proxy and prefixed with `/api` , except health paths. Request and response schemas are maintained in the Postman collection at `docs/postman/dost-meeting-mgnt.postman_collection.json` . Access rules are in section 7.2.

6.1 Authentication and Users

Method	Path	Purpose
POST	`/auth/register`	Create a staff account and issue a session.
POST	`/auth/login`	Authenticate and issue a session.
GET	`/auth/me`	Return the current user.
GET	`/users`	List users for assignment and participation.
PUT	`/users/:id`	Update a user's profile, role, or password. Admin only; not one's own account.
DELETE	`/users/:id`	Delete a user. Admin only; not one's own account.

6.2 Meetings, Participants, and Change Requests

Method	Path	Purpose
POST	`/meetings`	Create a meeting.

Method	Path	Purpose
GET	`/meetings`	List accessible meetings with pagination, filters, search. Admins see all; `scope=mine` limits to their own.
GET	`/meetings/:id`	Read a meeting with participants and related records.
PUT	`/meetings/:id`	Update a meeting; enforces valid status transitions.
DELETE	`/meetings/:id`	Delete a meeting.
GET	`/meetings/:meetingId/participants`	List participants.
POST	`/meetings/:meetingId/participants`	Add participants with a role.
PATCH	`/meetings/:meetingId/participants/:userId`	Change a participant's role.
DELETE	`/meetings/:meetingId/participants/:userId`	Remove a participant; organizer safeguards apply.
POST	`/meetings/:meetingId/change-requests`	Attendee sends a change request to the owner.
GET	`/meetings/:meetingId/change-requests`	Owner reads the change-request inbox.
GET	`/meetings/:meetingId/change-requests/:userId`	Owner reads one participant's requests.
PATCH	`/meetings/:meetingId/change-requests/:requestId/read`	Owner marks a request as read.

6.3 Meeting Requests

Method	Path	Purpose
POST	`/meeting-requests`	Create a scheduling request.
GET	`/meeting-requests/:requestId`	Read request detail, time options, invitees, and status.
PUT	`/meeting-requests/:requestId`	Update request details.
PUT	`/meeting-requests/:requestId/time-options`	Replace candidate time options.
PUT	`/meeting-requests/:requestId/invitees`	Replace invitees.
POST	`/meeting-requests/:requestId/send-invitations`	Email personal invitation links to invitees.
GET	`/meeting-requests/:requestId/invitees/:inviteeId`	Read invitee-specific request detail.
PUT	`/meeting-requests/:requestId/invitees/:inviteeId/availability`	Submit availability.
POST	`/meeting-requests/:requestId/confirm`	Confirm the selected time and create the meeting.
DELETE	`/meeting-requests/:requestId`	Cancel the request and its linked meeting, if any.
GET	`/public/invitations/:token`	Read an invitation with its link; no sign-in.

Method	Path	Purpose
PUT	`/public/invitations/:token/availability`	Submit availability with the link; no sign-in.

6.4 Files, Recordings, Minutes, AI Review, and Action Items

Method	Path	Purpose
POST	`/meetings/:meetingId/files`	Upload a meeting material.
GET	`/meetings/:meetingId/files`	List meeting files.
GET	`/files/:id/download`	Return a short-lived download link.
GET	`/files/:id/content`	Stream file content.
DELETE	`/files/:id`	Delete a file.
GET	`/meetings/:meetingId/recording`	Get the active recording and its generation status.
PUT	`/meetings/:meetingId/recording`	Upload or replace the recording (audio only).
DELETE	`/meetings/:meetingId/recording`	Archive the active recording.
POST	`/meetings/:meetingId/recording/generate`	Start transcription and analysis.
GET	`/meetings/:meetingId/recording/analysis`	Read the latest analysis, suggestions, and transcript.
GET	`/meetings/:meetingId/workflow/events`	Stream workflow status updates (SSE).
GET	`/meetings/:meetingId/minutes`	Read or initialize minutes.
PUT	`/meetings/:meetingId/minutes`	Update minutes and their status (draft, approved, published).
PUT	`/meetings/:meetingId/minutes/:minutesId`	Update a specific minutes record.
POST	`/meetings/:meetingId/minutes/apply-generated`	Apply the generated summary to draft minutes.
PATCH	`/meetings/:meetingId/analysis-suggestions/:suggestionId`	Edit a proposed action-item suggestion.
POST	`/meetings/:meetingId/analysis-suggestions/:suggestionId/accept`	Accept a suggestion and create the action item.
POST	`/meetings/:meetingId/analysis-suggestions/:suggestionId/reject`	Reject a suggestion.
GET	`/meetings/:meetingId/action-items`	List a meeting's action items.
POST	`/meetings/:meetingId/action-items`	Create an action item.
GET	`/action-items`	List my items (`scope=mine`) or items in meetings I own (`scope=owned`).
GET	`/action-items/:id`	Read one action item.

Method	Path	Purpose
PUT	`/action-items/:id`	Update content, assignee, status, or priority.
DELETE	`/action-items/:id`	Delete an action item.

6.5 Dashboard, Notifications, Tags, and Health

Health paths have no `/api` prefix so infrastructure can check them directly.

Method	Path	Purpose
GET	`/dashboard`	Dashboard aggregate data.
GET	`/notifications/summary`	Latest topbar notification state.
GET	`/notifications`	Paginated notifications.
POST	`/notifications/:id/read`	Mark one notification as read.
POST	`/notifications/read`	Mark selected notifications as read.
POST	`/notifications/read-all`	Mark all notifications as read.
POST	`/notifications/:id/archive`	Archive one notification.
POST	`/notifications/archive-read`	Archive all read notifications.
GET	`/tags`	List meeting tags.
POST	`/tags`	Create a meeting tag.
GET	`/health/live`	Confirm the process is running.
GET	`/health/ready`	Confirm PostgreSQL, Redis, and MinIO are reachable.
GET	`/health`	Readiness status and process uptime.

7. Security Requirements

7.1 Authentication and Session Security

- Require an authenticated session for everything except login, registration, health, and personal invitation links.
- Store only hashed passwords; never return hashes, secrets, or credentials.
- Keep production secrets in the deployment environment, not in committed files.
- Session lifetime is configurable (default 7 days).
- Read the account role from the database on every request, so a role change takes effect immediately.

7.2 Authorization

Permissions are enforced on the server by one central definition. Access is granted when either the account role or the meeting role matches.

Capability	Who
View a meeting and its participants, minutes, files, recording, analysis, and action items	Admin, owner, organizer, attendee, optional
Upload and download files; create, update, and delete action items	Admin, owner, organizer, attendee, optional
Update or delete the meeting; manage participants; delete files; update minutes and approve or publish them; manage recordings; review AI suggestions	Admin, owner, organizer
Send a change request	Attendee, optional
Read change requests	Owner only (admins and organizers excluded for privacy)
Create a meeting or meeting request; list users and tags	Any signed-in user
Manage, invite for, confirm, or cancel a meeting request	Request creator
Submit invitee availability	The invitee or the request creator
Manage user accounts and roles	Admin (not their own account)

Additional rules:

- An action-item assignee can view that item and change only its status.
- Non-participants have no access to a meeting or its records.
- The owner cannot be removed or demoted, and the last organizer cannot be removed or demoted.
- Role values are limited to `staff` and `admin`, enforced by the API and the database.

7.3 Input Validation

- Validate all external input at the API boundary: identifiers, dates, time ranges, statuses, roles, priorities, and search parameters.
- Reject malformed values early with consistent error responses.
- Bound free-text search inputs.
- Limit uploads to 50 MB per file and validate file type per workflow.

7.4 Network and Proxy Security

- Keep the reverse proxy as the only public entrypoint; keep the API, database, Redis, MinIO, AI worker, and Ollama on private networks.
- Use HTTPS for browser traffic.
- Rate-limit the API and use proxy-aware client IP handling.
- Do not expose administrative consoles publicly.

7.5 File and Object Storage Security

- Require meeting access before listing, uploading, streaming, or downloading files.

- Use short-lived presigned download links.
- Separate meeting files, recordings, and AI artifacts into different buckets.
- Limit upload size and validate file type before storing (see 7.3).

8. Non-Functional Characteristics

Area	Requirement or current behavior
Performance	AI processing benchmark on CPU: about 18 minutes for a 26-minute recording (about 12 transcription, 6 analysis). Not a service level.
Performance	API rate limit of 100 requests per 5 minutes per client IP by default; configurable.
Capacity	Expected use: 10,000 employees, 1,000–2,000 daily active users (project plan).
Capacity	Initial AI host: 8 vCPU / 16 GiB RAM for low volume, 16 vCPU / 32 GiB for a small pilot; one AI worker. Concurrent long recordings need capacity testing.
Availability	Current deployment is single-host and not highly available. Liveness and readiness endpoints support monitoring.
Backup	Verified PostgreSQL backup before every release with migrations; MinIO backup on a defined schedule; restore drills. Redis is not a backup.
Logging	Request failures and workflow errors are written to service logs. AI logs must not contain transcript text or credentials.
Traceability	AI results record transcript, provider, model, and prompt version; suggestion reviews record reviewer and time.

9. Assumptions and Constraints

9.1 Assumptions

- Deployment is on-premise. Recordings and transcripts are processed by local Whisper and Ollama; no external AI service is used.
- Email delivery (SMTP or Resend) is available for invitations, confirmations, and calendar updates.
- Browsers can reach MinIO over HTTPS for presigned downloads.
- AI output is advisory and is reviewed by a person before it is used.

9.2 Constraints

Constraint	Impact
Single-host deployment (Docker Compose for PostgreSQL, Redis, MinIO; systemd for API and worker)	Host or disk failure causes outage; not a high-availability design.
PostgreSQL, Redis, and MinIO are single-node	Backups and restore tests are required even for a pilot.
CPU AI is the only verified path; the GPU profile is an unverified benchmark option	Processing takes minutes per recording.
Transcription and analysis language defaults to English	Other languages need configuration and evaluation.

Constraint	Impact
Uploads are limited to 50 MB per file, including recordings and audio extracted from a video	A recording above 50 MB cannot be uploaded; at 128 kbps that is about 52 minutes of audio.
Audio extraction from video runs in the browser and supports MP4, MOV, WebM, and MKV	Other formats (for example AVI) must be converted to audio before upload.
Minutes approval sets a status only; the approver and the time are not recorded	Approval history is not available.
Redis must not evict Stream data when AI is enabled	Requires the `noeviction` memory policy.
Registration is self-service	Anyone who can reach the application can create a `staff` account.

10. Deployment

10.1 Deployment Model

1. Browser traffic reaches Caddy over HTTPS.
2. Caddy serves the built React application and forwards API and health requests to the private API service.
3. The API connects to PostgreSQL, Redis, and MinIO over private networks.
4. When AI is enabled, the Node workflow worker dispatches outbox events and consumes results, while the Python AI worker runs Whisper and Ollama jobs.

The deployment is a single host: Docker Compose runs PostgreSQL, Redis, and MinIO; systemd runs the API and workflow worker. It is not a high-availability design.

Host bootstrap, release, backup, automated deployment, and AI operations procedures are in `docs/deployment-guidelines.md`. The optional GPU profile is in `docs/gpu-benchmark-runbook.md`.

10.2 Environment Configuration

Production values are set per environment and stored in the client's secret-management mechanism. `.env.example` is the reference list of variable names.

Area	Variables
Runtime	`NODE_ENV`, `PORT`, `TRUST_PROXY`, `RATE_LIMIT_WINDOW_MS`, `RATE_LIMIT_MAX`
Database	`DATABASE_URL`, `POSTGRES_USER`, `POSTGRES_PASSWORD`, `POSTGRES_DB`
Redis	`REDIS_URL`
Object storage	`MINIO_ENDPOINT`, `MINIO_PORT`, `MINIO_USE_SSL`, `MINIO_ACCESS_KEY`, `MINIO_SECRET_KEY`, `MINIO_BUCKET_FILES`, `MINIO_BUCKET_AUDIO`, `MINIO_BUCKET_AI_RESULTS`
Authentication	`JWT_SECRET`, `JWT_EXPIRES_IN`
Email	`EMAIL_PROVIDER` (`smtp` or `resend`), `EMAIL_FROM`, `CLIENT_URL`, `INVITATION_TOKEN_TTL_DAYS`, `SMTP_*` or `RESEND_API_KEY`
Web application	`VITE_API_BASE_URL` (same-origin behind Caddy)

Area	Variables
AI	`AI_PIPELINE_ENABLED`, `AI_TRANSCRIPTION_PROVIDER` (`whisper`), `AI_ANALYSIS_PROVIDER` (`llm`), `WHISPER_MODEL`, `OLLAMA_MODEL`
Automated deployment	`DEPLOY_HOST`, `DEPLOY_USER`, `DEPLOY_SSH_KEY` (secrets); `DEPLOY_PATH`, service names (variables)

11. Testing and Validation

Scope	Validation expectation
Functional testing	Login, dashboard, meeting creation, scheduling requests, files, minutes, recording review.
API testing	Authentication, validation errors, pagination, status transitions.
Permission testing	Each capability in 7.2 for admin, owner, organizer, attendee, optional, and non-participant.
Database testing	Migration application, integrity constraints, relationship behavior.
File testing	Upload, download, stream, delete, size limits, unauthorized access rejection.
Security testing	Protected routes, rate limiting, private change requests, admin-only account management.
Deployment smoke testing	Liveness and readiness, login, dashboard, core meeting workflow, file access.
Load testing	Dashboard, meeting search, meeting detail, uploads, and action-item updates.

Readiness health fails when PostgreSQL, Redis, or MinIO is unavailable. Liveness only confirms the process is running.

12. Delivered Scope

Item	Description
Core meeting management	Create, list/search, detail, participants, files, minutes, action items.
Meeting request scheduling	Email invitations with personal links; creators confirm after responses or deadline.
Calendar invitations	iCalendar emails on create, update, and cancel.
Attendee change requests	Private attendee messages to the owner, with notification and inbox.
Dashboard and notifications	Upcoming meetings, requests, action items, notification state.
Video recordings	The browser extracts the audio track before upload; the video is not uploaded.
Speech-to-text transcription	Whisper transcripts with timestamped segments.
AI summaries and action-item review	Local LLM summaries, decisions, and suggestions reviewed by a person.
Minutes review and approval	Reviewed AI output is applied to draft minutes, then approved and published by the owner, organizer, or admin.
RBAC and admin controls	Account roles, admin user management, and central permission checks (see 7.2).